Still passing urine: why might dialysis be needed?

> *It is reasonable to ask. Urine volume and adequate blood cleaning are different measures.*

What the urine does not tell you

Some people retain kidney function after dialysis begins. Passing urine does not by itself show that waste, potassium and fluid are adequately controlled. Dialysis removes waste and excess fluid; it is not a cure for kidney failure.

How your plan is chosen

Your team considers blood results, symptoms, fluid balance, remaining kidney function and treatment adequacy. **Keep the prescribed schedule.** Discuss travel, work and financial difficulties rather than skipping a session. **Do not reduce frequency** because another person has fewer sessions.

Food and fluid need their own plan

There is no universal one-litre allowance or very-low-protein diet for everyone on dialysis. Nutrition needs differ with treatment and health. Ask how drinks and liquid foods count towards an allowance, and bring your medicine list and recent results.

A useful home record

Record the observations requested by your team: weight, swelling, breathing, appetite and changes in urine. Ask which changes need a same-day call and who to contact after hours. This record supports, rather than replaces, laboratory monitoring.

Seek help promptly

Contact the dialysis team the same day after a missed session or marked new swelling. Severe breathlessness, chest pain or collapse requires emergency care, not an online appointment.

> For a life-threatening emergency in India, call 112. Elsewhere use your local emergency number.

Questions you may have

Can I reduce sessions if I still urinate?

Only the nephrology team can change your prescription after assessing the whole picture.

What to remember

Keep the agreed schedule; ask for an individual review rather than copying another person’s treatment.

Sources and further reading

NIDDK — hemodialysis
https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/kidney-disease/kidney-failure/hemodialysis

NIDDK — healthy eating with chronic kidney disease
https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/kidney-disease/chronic-kidney-disease-ckd/healthy-eating-adults-chronic-kidney-disease

NIDDK — eating and nutrition on hemodialysis
https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/kidney-disease/kidney-failure/hemodialysis/eating-nutrition

American Heart Association — changes to report
https://www.heart.org/en/health-topics/heart-failure/living-with-heart-failure-and-managing-advanced-hf/physical-changes-to-report-for-heart-failure

Government of India — Emergency Response Support System 112
https://112.gov.in/about

Educational information supports understanding and does not replace individual medical care. Follow your clinician’s plan. Do not change medicines on your own. Sources checked: 24 October 2026.

Website: https://home-visiting-icu-doctor.vercel.app/#wikiSection
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